Director's Playbook

Everything from now to the first Thursday, one week at a time, plus how to hire, how registration works, and what happens every Thursday.

CALENDAR: NOW TO JANUARY 7

Oct 26	Thursday, Oct 29: meet with Josh and Brent. Bring the handout.
Nov 2	Ask the church to set up background checks, payroll, insurance, the check-in system, and kdo@firstalma.com. Call the fire marshal to schedule a walkthrough. Ask the state for the exemption letter. Decide with the bookkeeper how tuition is collected. Share the teacher application link everywhere.
Nov 9	Call new applicants within 2 or 3 days. Call their references. Start interviews and background checks.
Nov 16	Keep interviewing. Mark teachers Approved or Sub in the sheet. Sign staff up for CPR and first aid. Send everyone the mandated reporter course.
Nov 23	Thanksgiving week. Finish hiring: 6 teachers and at least 2 subs. Hiring paperwork goes to the bookkeeper.
Nov 30	**Tuesday, Dec 1: registration opens.** Post it in the bulletin, on Facebook, and at story time. Text or email families as they sign up.
Dec 7	Training with Melissa. Safe sleep training for the baby room. Keep confirming spots in sign-up order.
Dec 14	Fire marshal walkthrough, with approval in writing. Buy supplies ($30 a child). Set up the rooms.
Dec 21	Christmas week, keep it light. Remind families the first payment is due by January 7.
Dec 28	Set up check-in. Print room lists, allergy lists, and emergency contacts. Start the drill log binder.
Jan 4	Parent open house (Sunday, January 3 after church works well). Staff run-through. **Thursday, Jan 7: first KDO day. First payment due.**

HIRING TEACHERS AND SUBS

1. **Share the link:** firstalma-kdo.vercel.app/apply.html. Applications land on the Leaders tab of the sheet as Applied.
2. **Call within 2 or 3 days.** Then call the reference.
3. **Short in-person interview**, ideally with Josh there.
4. **Background check** through the church before anyone is approved.
5. **Set their status** to Approved or Sub. Every 2 approved teachers opens a room.
6. **Paperwork** goes through the church bookkeeper: tax forms, the work eligibility form, and payroll.
7. **Training before January:** Melissa's training, CPR and first aid, Arkansas's free online mandated reporter training, and safe sleep for anyone in the baby room.
8. **Keep 1 or 2 subs for every open room**, not just enough teachers.

Good interview questions:

- Tell me about a time you cared for young children.
- A toddler bites another child. What do you do?
- Someone you don't recognize comes to pick up a child. What do you do?
- A child cries for mom all morning. How do you help?
- Why do you want to serve at KDO?

REGISTRATION AND PAYMENTS

- Families register at firstalma-kdo.vercel.app starting December 1. Each child shows up on the Kids tab in the order they signed up.
- A child with a spot shows **Spot held**. Text or email the family to welcome them, then set them to **Confirmed** once their first payment is in. Set **Withdrawn** if they drop out, and the next family on the waitlist moves up.
- Families pay by the 7th of each month, January through May. One toddler or preschooler is **$93 a month**, one baby is **$113**. May is smaller since it has only 2 Thursdays.
- 10% off for siblings. 10% off for paying the semester in full by January 7.
- If a payment is more than 2 weeks late, the spot can go to the next family on the waitlist.
- Decide with the bookkeeper how payments come in and where they're tracked. The sheet doesn't track payments.

EVERY THURSDAY

- **8:30:** staff arrive, set up, and pray together.
- **9:00:** doors open and families check in.
- **2:00:** pickup, tagged pickup only.
- **2:30:** rooms clean and back the way we found them.
- Two adults in every room, all day. No adult is ever alone with a child.
- Kids under 3 and kids 3 and up stay in separate rooms.
- Send families a quick update in Homeroom. Only share photos of kids whose families said yes.

EVERY MONTH

- One fire drill and one tornado drill, written in the drill log every time.
- Check who has paid by the 7th.
- Look at the Leaders tab for new applicants and keep the sub list full.

WHERE EVERYTHING LIVES

- **Sign-up sheet:** the KDO Sign-ups Google Sheet. Kids, Leaders, and Summary tabs. You only change the Status column and the Settings.
- **Website:** firstalma-kdo.vercel.app. Teachers apply at /apply.html.
- **Every document:** firstalma-kdo.vercel.app/files.html
- **Email:** kdo@firstalma.com